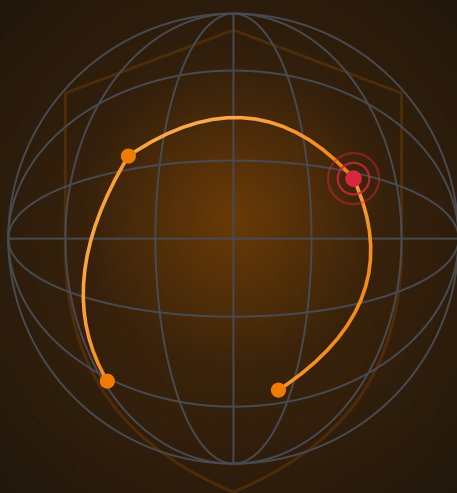




THREAT PULSE

WEEKLY CYBER THREAT BRIEFING

WEEK IN REVIEW · 21–27 SEPTEMBER 2026

Inside this week: a **critical WordPress flaw** exploited within hours of the fix — on the software running **43% of the web** — plus dual **Citrix NetScaler** zero-days and a critical **WSO2** bug already hitting ~1,000 organisations — explained in plain English, with the practical steps that matter.

Welcome to **Threat Pulse**, your plain-English weekly round-up of the cyber threats making waves around the world — and what they mean for your business. This week's standout story is about scale: a critical flaw in **WordPress**, the software behind roughly **43% of all websites**, was fixed on 22 September — and attackers were already exploiting it within hours. No jargon, just what happened and the practical steps worth taking.

AT A GLANCE THIS WEEK

 **9.2 /10**

Severity of the WordPress flaw exploited within hours of the fix

 **1,000+**

Organisations already hit by a critical flaw in WSO2 business software

 **43%**

Share of all websites built on WordPress — the software this week's headline flaw affects

THIS WEEK'S HEADLINE THREAT

WORDPRESS CORE • CVE-2026-87902

A critical WordPress flaw was exploited within hours of the fix going out



CRITICAL

Exploitation: **active, within hours of the fix**

WHAT'S HAPPENING

A serious flaw (**CVSS 9.2**) in **WordPress Core** — the software behind roughly **43% of all websites** — lets an attacker who isn't logged in read and write files on the server, opening the door to **full remote takeover**. WordPress fixed it on **22 September** (version 7.1.2, plus backports for older 7.0.x, 6.9.x and 6.8.x), but attackers began exploiting unpatched sites **within hours** — it's now on the US government's list of **known-exploited** vulnerabilities.

WHO'S AFFECTED

Any business running a **self-hosted WordPress site** not yet on **7.1.2** (or the matching 7.0.6 / 6.9.9 / 6.8.10 backport) — a very large share of company websites, blogs and online shops. Fully-managed WordPress.com sites aren't affected the same way, but if your IT team or web agency manages your own install, check it now.

WHY IT MATTERS TO YOU

An unpatched, exploited site can be **defaced, mined for customer data, or used to plant malware** on your visitors — no username or password needed. Given how fast this was weaponised, every unpatched day is real exposure.

Good news: the fix is already out, and updating WordPress Core is normally a one-click job from the dashboard (or automatic, with auto-updates on). Most hosts and web agencies patch managed sites quickly — if you're unsure whether yours has, that's worth checking today.

What to do about the headline threat

-  If you or your web agency run a **self-hosted WordPress site**, update to **7.1.2** (or the matching 7.0.6 / 6.9.9 / 6.8.10 backport) today.
-  Turn on **automatic core updates** in WordPress so future fixes install themselves without waiting on anyone.
-  Ask your host or web agency to **confirm in writing** that your site has been patched — don't assume it happened automatically.

OTHER THREATS WORTH KNOWING ABOUT



HIGH

Two Citrix NetScaler zero-days are being actively exploited

Citrix has confirmed active exploitation of **two unauthenticated remote-code-execution zero-days** (CVE-2026-88771 and CVE-2026-88772, both CVSS 9.5) in its NetScaler ADC and Gateway appliances — the devices many firms use for remote access and load-balancing. Patches are out (14.1-73.37 / 13.1-64.23); both flaws are now on CISA's KEV list.

Takeaway: if you run NetScaler, patch immediately and treat it as already compromised until you've checked the logs.



HIGH

A critical flaw in business software has already hit ~1,000 organisations

A serious bug in **WSO2** business-integration software (CVE-2026-5430, CVSS 9.8) lets an attacker upload and run their own files on the server **without logging in**. It has been exploited since 13 September, with roughly **1,000 organisations** affected across banking, government, telecoms and logistics. A fix (3.30.2) is available.

Takeaway: if you use WSO2 products, patch now and check for signs of unusual file uploads.



MEDIUM

Online shops built on Adobe Commerce are being targeted

A flaw in **Adobe Commerce and Magento** (CVE-2026-71362, CVSS 9.1) lets an attacker **take over customer accounts and active sessions** on online stores built on the platform. It is now on CISA's list of exploited vulnerabilities. Adobe has released a fix.

Takeaway: if you run an online shop on Adobe Commerce or Magento, apply the update and review recent customer-account activity for anything unusual.

**Your 3-minute checklist this week**

- ✓ Update any self-hosted **WordPress site** to **7.1.2** (or the right backport) today — don't wait for the next maintenance window.
- ✓ If you run **Citrix NetScaler** or **WSO2** products, patch them now and check logs for signs of prior compromise.
- ✓ If you sell online via **Adobe Commerce or Magento**, apply the update and review recent customer-account activity.
- ✓ Remind staff to **pause and verify** any unexpected request for money, log-ins or data.

Threat Pulse is provided by DPG-Cyber for general awareness only and does not constitute specific security or legal advice. Threat details are drawn from reputable public reporting as at 28 September 2026 and may evolve as investigations continue. For guidance tailored to your environment, please contact your DPG-Cyber account team.

BEHIND THE HEADLINES

Why a **watchful eye** changes the outcome

Every threat in this issue had one thing in common: the damage happened in the **quiet gap between the break-in and the moment someone noticed**. Tools alone rarely stop an attack — what limits the harm is continuous monitoring that correlates the signals, spots the intrusion early, and responds before a foothold becomes a crisis.

247 days

Average time for organisations to identify *and* contain a breach

SOURCE: IBM COST OF A DATA BREACH 2026

\$4.99M

Global average total cost of a single data breach

SOURCE: IBM COST OF A DATA BREACH 2026

THE WINDOW THAT MATTERS

Intrusion
the way in

Foothold
quietly settling in

Lateral movement
spreading across systems

Impact
data theft / ransomware

↑ The sooner an attack is spotted, the smaller the damage. Closing this window — detecting and responding on the left, long before impact on the right — is the entire job of a Security Operations Centre.

WHAT CONTINUOUS MONITORING QUIETLY DOES



Sees across everything

A SIEM gathers and correlates activity from across your systems, so unusual behaviour stands out instead of hiding in the noise.



Watches around the clock

Attacks don't keep office hours. A SOC means real people monitoring day, night and weekends — not just 9 to 5.



Knows the latest tactics

Fresh threat intelligence — like the WordPress and network-appliance attacks in this issue — feeds detection so new tricks are recognised fast.



Acts, not just alerts

Alerts are triaged and investigated by analysts who step in early, turning a would-be incident into a non-event.

CLIENT ACTION OF THE WEEK

THIS WEEK'S FIX

Patch WordPress today, don't wait

If your business runs a self-hosted **WordPress** site, update to **7.1.2** (or the matching backport) now — this flaw went from patch to active exploitation in **hours**, not weeks.

GOOD HABIT

Turn on multi-factor authentication (MFA)

Make sure **MFA is switched on** for email, admin logins and anywhere else it's offered — especially on website and hosting dashboards. It's the single cheapest step that stops most stolen passwords being used.

This is the quiet, everyday work behind **DPG-Cyber's SIEM & SOC services** — the same monitoring and response that turns headlines like these into non-events for the businesses we look after. If you're ever curious how it would map to your own environment, we're always happy to talk it through, no pressure — just drop us a line at hello@dpg-cyber.com.